



■ BRAND GUIDELINES

Your work, represented.

Version 1.0 · September 2026

Inside

BRAND	LOGO	COLOR	TYPE AND MOTIF	IN USE
Why Halo exists03	The logo07	Palette13	Typography16	Product interface20
What we believe04	Anatomy and construction08	Proportion14	Type scale17	App icon and favicon21
Personality05	Lockups09	Accessible pairings15	Motif system18	Print and email22
Voice and tone06	Clear space and minimum size10		Iconography19	Social and web23
	Color versions11			Assets and contact24
	Misuse12			

“Because I’m tired of being paperwork for my own work.”

■ WHY HALO EXISTS

Every week, capable people lose hours to writing status updates, sitting in status meetings and grooming tickets. Halo takes that coordination work off their plate. It turns the signal they already create into updates in their own voice, so the work speaks for itself.

What we believe

Four principles decide every product and brand call. When two ideas conflict, the one that protects the individual wins.

01

IC-first

Halo speaks for the person, never about them. If a choice makes someone feel watched, it's wrong, even if a manager would love it.

02

Signal, not paperwork

Halo populates itself from work that already happened. Nobody should maintain a tool so the tool can describe their work.

03

Right altitude

The same truth, written for whoever asks: detail for a teammate, risk for a manager, one sentence for an executive.

04

Visible restraint

Trust comes from showing what was held back. "Redacted: 1 private topic" beats silent omission.

Personality

If Halo were a colleague, it would be the calm, precise one who always has your back and never needs credit.

Calm	Precise	On your side	Quietly confident
■ IS Unhurried, clear, generous with space. ■ IS NOT Loud, urgent, busy.	■ IS Specific facts, sources shown, numbers that add up. ■ IS NOT Vague, hype, invented stats.	■ IS An advocate that protects your time and privacy. ■ IS NOT A monitor, a scorecard, a boss.	■ IS Says what it knows, admits what it doesn't. ■ IS NOT Hedging, apologetic, smug.

Voice and tone

Write like a trusted teammate: warm, direct and brief. Halo always speaks in first person on the individual's behalf.

■ Sentence case, plain words.

■ Say “share”, not “report”.

■ No exclamation marks, no emojis.

■ Never “monitor”, “track you” or “productivity score”.

■ SAY

Heads up: the selector needs a day more than planned. New target is Thursday.

■ NOT

~~URGENT!!! Timeline slipping on CHK-142, will circle back ASAP.~~

■ SAY

4 updates need you. It takes about two minutes.

■ NOT

~~You have 4 pending items requiring immediate review.~~

■ SAY

Halo held back 1 update that matches a private topic.

■ NOT

~~Some content was filtered for compliance reasons.~~

■ SAY

Rosa asked about Checkout v3. Here's exactly what Halo said.

■ NOT

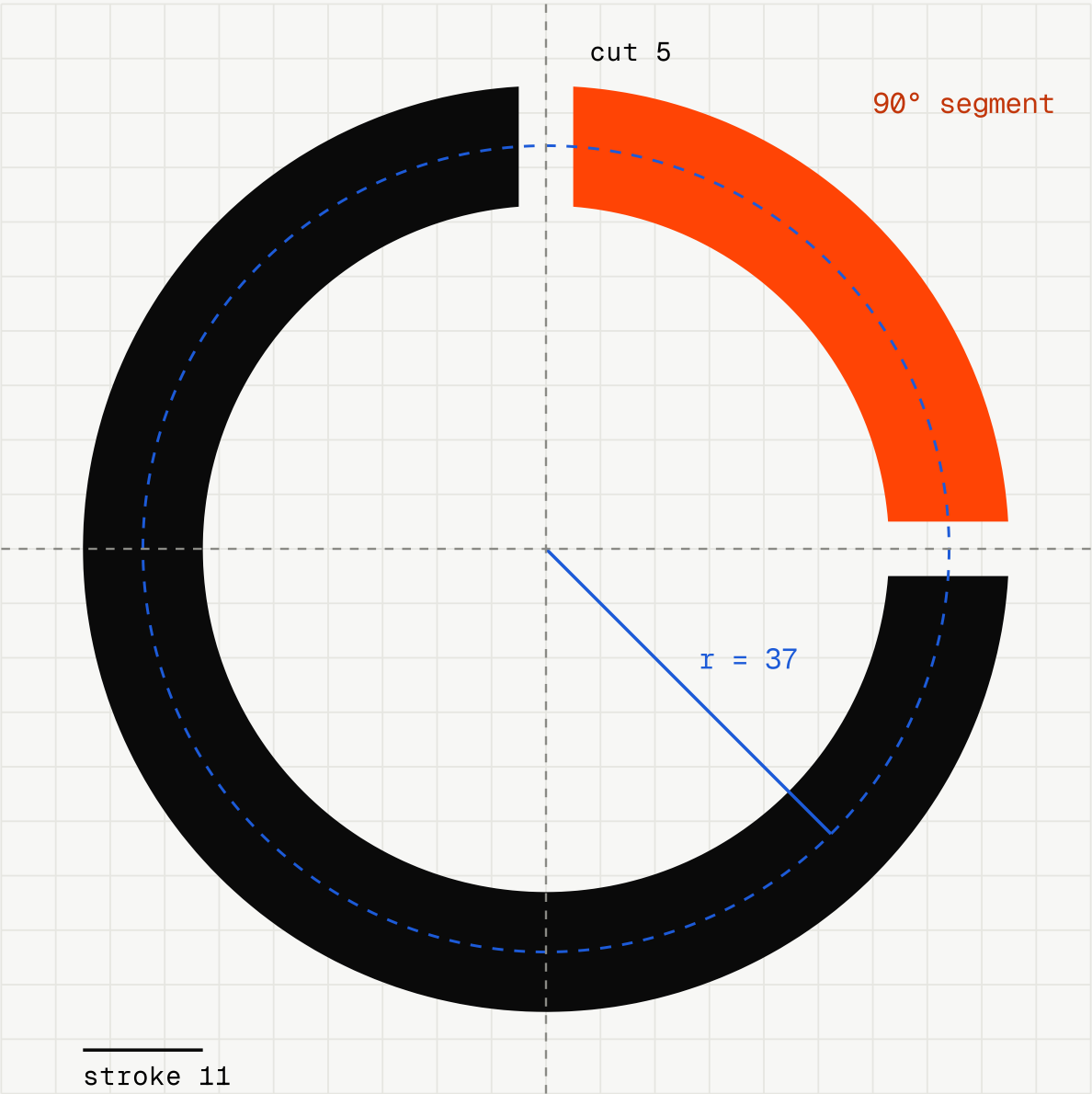
~~Your manager has been monitoring your activity.~~

The logo

A precise ring with a single Signal segment. The ring is the boundary Halo keeps around your work; the segment is the one thing that matters right now.



Anatomy and construction



The mark is geometric and flat. Never redraw it; always use the master files.

Artboard 100 × 100 units

Ring radius 37, stroke 11

Segment 0° to 90°, clockwise from 12 o'clock

Cuts parallel-sided, 5 units wide

Small sizes below 24 px use the heavier variant: radius 36, stroke 15, cuts 8

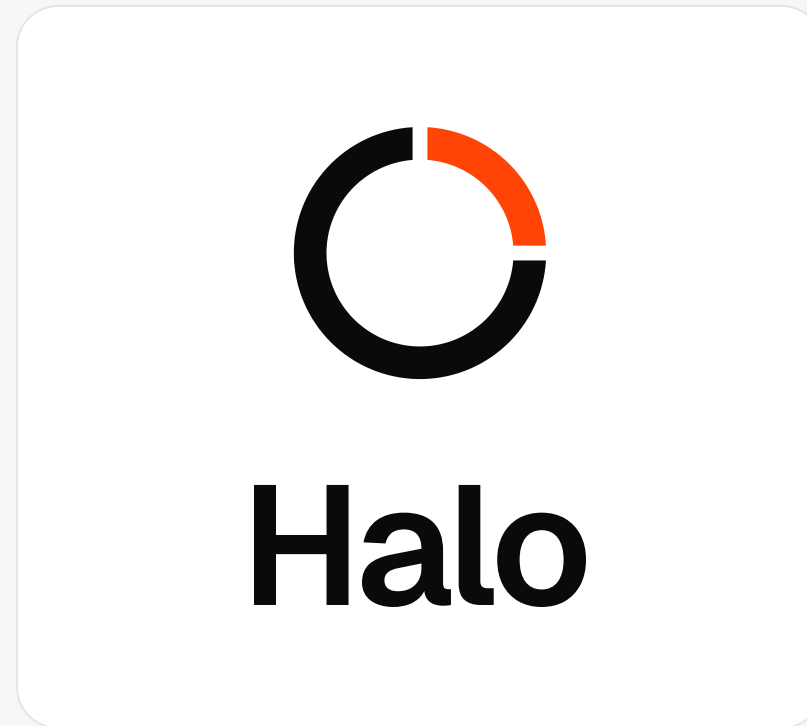
Wordmark Geist SemiBold, -3% tracking, outlined

Lockups

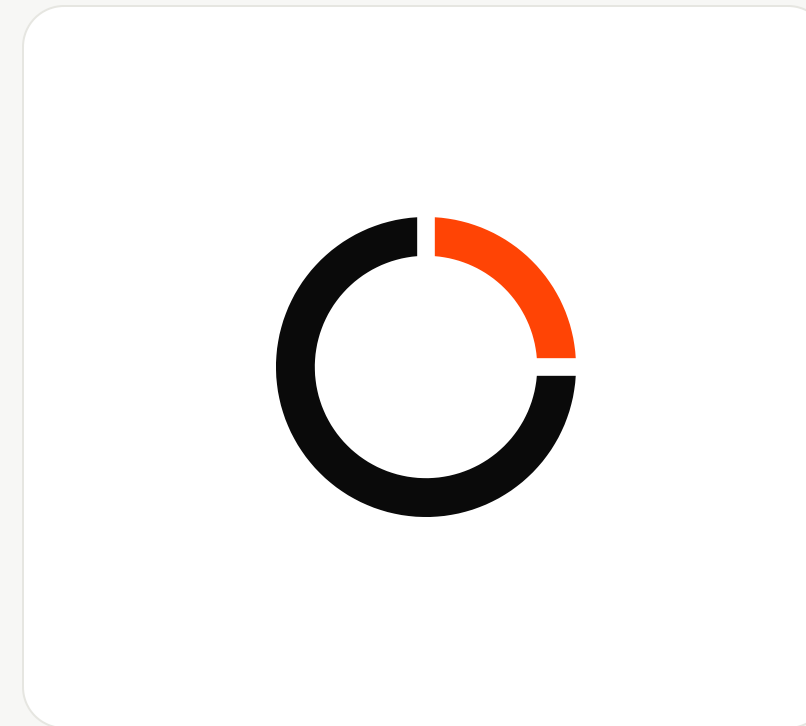
Mark and wordmark keep a fixed relationship: the mark is 1.3× the cap height, and the gap is 0.3× the mark.



Horizontal. The default. Use it whenever there is room.



Stacked. For square and tall spaces: app stores, merch, social.



Mark. When Halo is already named nearby: app icon, favicon, avatar.



Wordmark. Only in running text-heavy contexts where the mark repeats elsewhere.

Clear space and minimum size

Keep a clear space of 2X around the logo, where X is the ring's stroke width. Nothing enters that space.



Color versions

Four versions cover every surface. Pick the one with the strongest contrast; never recolor parts of the mark.



Color on light. The default.



Reversed on Midnight or Ink.



Ink on Signal. Never white on Signal.



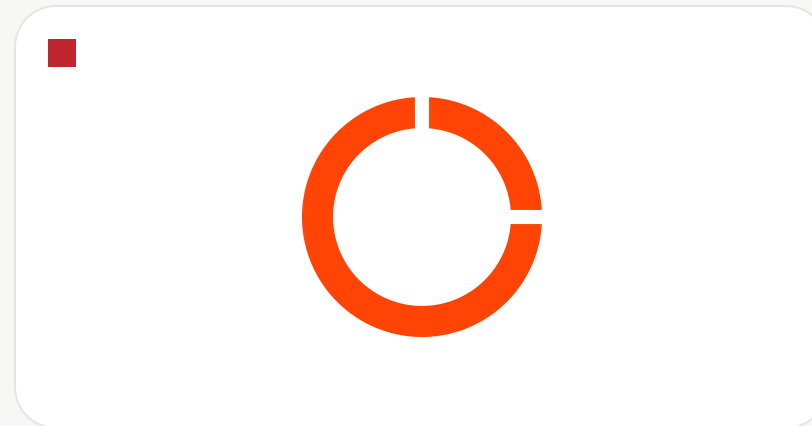
White, for single-color and photography.

Misuse

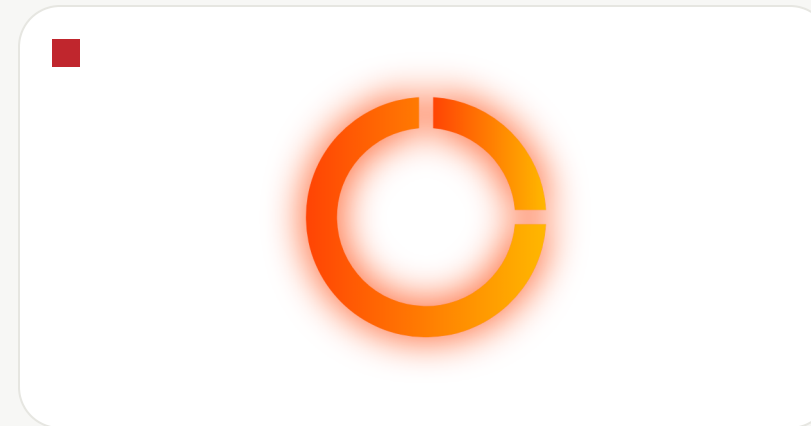
The logo only works when it's exact. These are the mistakes we see most.



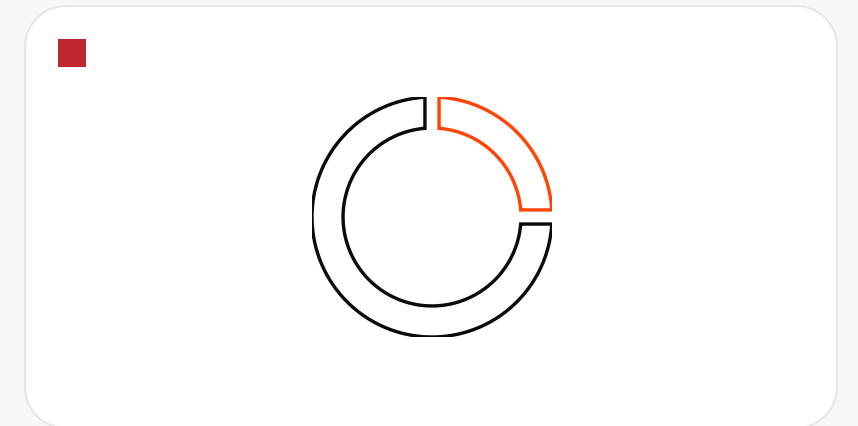
Don't rotate the mark.



Don't make the ring orange.



Don't add gradients or glow.



Don't outline it.



Don't stretch or squash.



Don't change the typeface.



Don't place it on busy imagery.



Don't add shadows or effects.

Palette

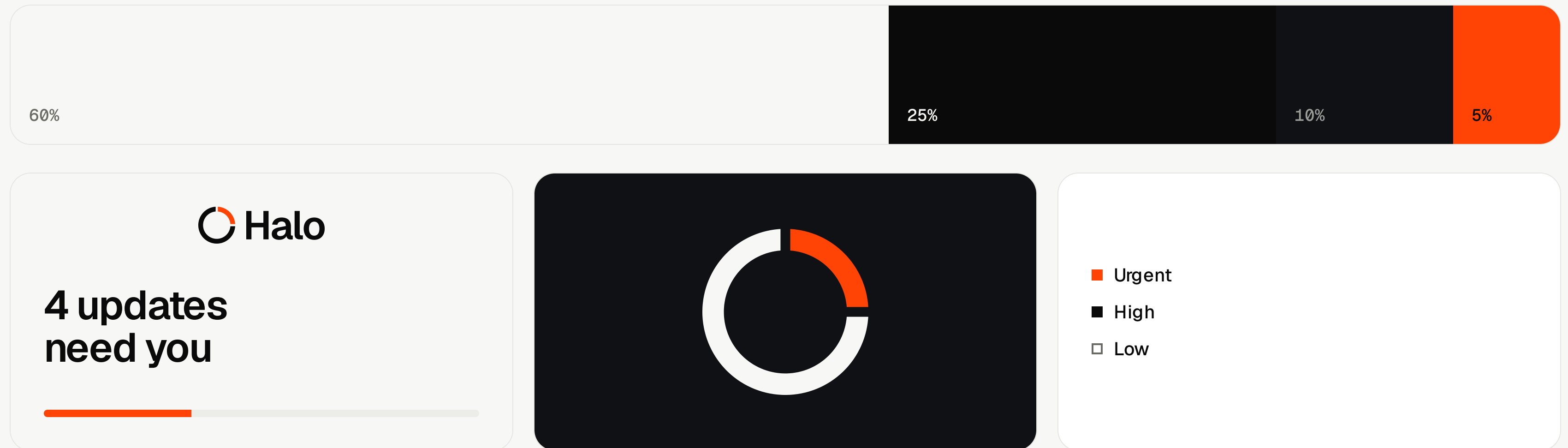
Mostly Canvas and Ink. Signal is used sparingly, so when it appears, it means something.

Canvas #F7F7F5 RGB 247 247 245 CMYK 0 0 1 3 Backgrounds, paper, the calm default.	Ink #0A0A0A RGB 10 10 10 CMYK 0 0 0 96 Type, the ring, primary actions.	Signal #FF4405 RGB 255 68 5 CMYK 0 73 98 0 The segment. Attention, progress, live. Flat only.	Midnight #0F1114 RGB 15 17 20 CMYK 25 15 0 92 Dark surfaces and reversed brand moments.	Signal Tint #FFEDE5 RGB 255 237 229 CMYK 0 7 10 0 Quiet highlights behind Signal Deep text.	Signal Deep #C2360A RGB 194 54 10 CMYK 0 72 95 24 Orange text and links on light backgrounds.
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Nearest Pantone for Signal: Orange 021 C. Always proof on press.

Proportion

Signal is always a segment, never the whole ring. Keep it to about five percent of any composition.



Accessible pairings

Every text color in the product meets WCAG 2.2 AA (4.5:1) in both light and dark. Ink on Signal passes at 5.73:1; white on Signal does not, so never use it.

LIGHT	ON CANVAS · ON SURFACE	
Text	18.46 · 19.80	AAA
Secondary text	8.17 · 8.76	AAA
Tertiary text	4.99 · 5.36	AA
Signal Deep text	5.12 · 5.49	AA
Success	5.40 · 5.80	AA
Warning	5.05 · 5.42	AA
Danger	5.50 · 5.90	AA
Info	5.53 · 5.93	AA

DARK	ON MIDNIGHT · ON SURFACE	
Text	16.86 · 15.85	AAA
Secondary text	10.78 · 10.14	AAA
Tertiary text	6.85 · 6.43	AA
Signal text	6.64 · 6.24	AA
Success	10.85 · 10.20	AAA
Warning	11.33 · 10.65	AAA
Danger	6.84 · 6.43	AA
Info	7.44 · 6.99	AA

Typography

One family, two voices. Geist carries every word in the product and the brand; Geist Mono handles data: keys, times and estimates.

GEIST · SEMIBOLD, MEDIUM, REGULAR

Aa

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz 0123456789

GEIST MONO · DATA

CHK-142
2:40 PM
11.5h left
85% likely

Both typefaces are free under the SIL Open Font License 1.1.

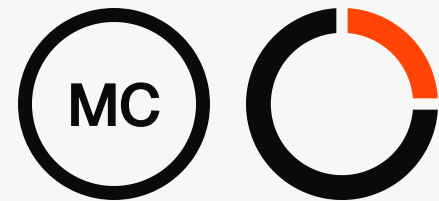
Type scale

A short scale with tight tracking at large sizes. Hierarchy comes from size and weight, never from color alone.

Display XL	64 / 64 · 600 · -4%	Your work, represented.
Display	44 / 48 · 600 · -3.5%	One dial, three levels of trust
Title 1	28 / 34 · 600 · -2.5%	Good afternoon, Maya
Title 3	17 / 24 · 600	Checkout v3: error states kickoff
Body	14 / 21 · 400	Routine updates share themselves. Sensitive ones wait for you.
Caption	12 / 16 · 500	Shared automatically · 2m ago
Micro	11 / 14 · 600 · +4% · caps	TODAY'S DIGEST

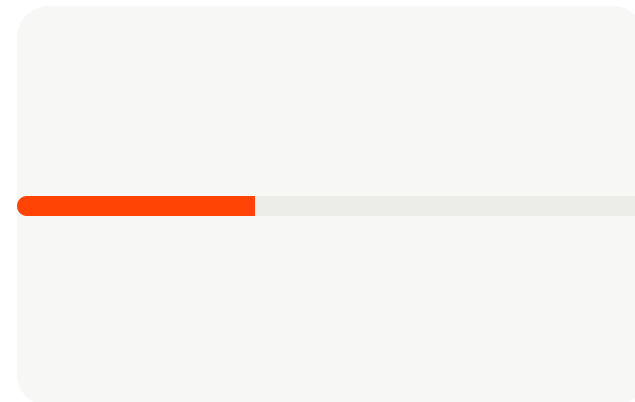
Motif system

Four ideas, all drawn from the mark. Use them to build layouts, illustrations and motion.



Boundary

The ring as a container: avatars, progress, frames. It says “this is yours.”



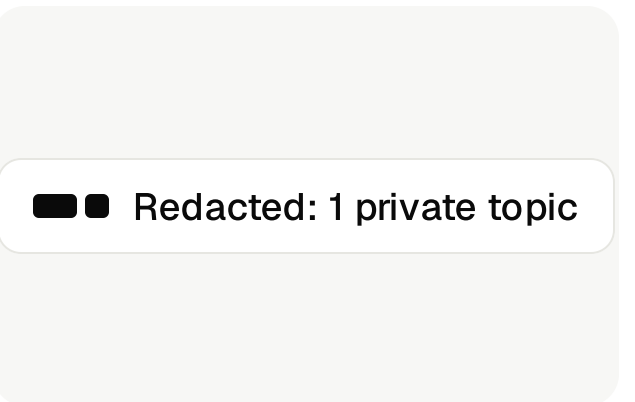
Segment

The Signal arc marks the one thing that matters: progress, attention, live.



Dial

Trust as a spectrum. The segment grows with automation: 45°, 150°, 270°.

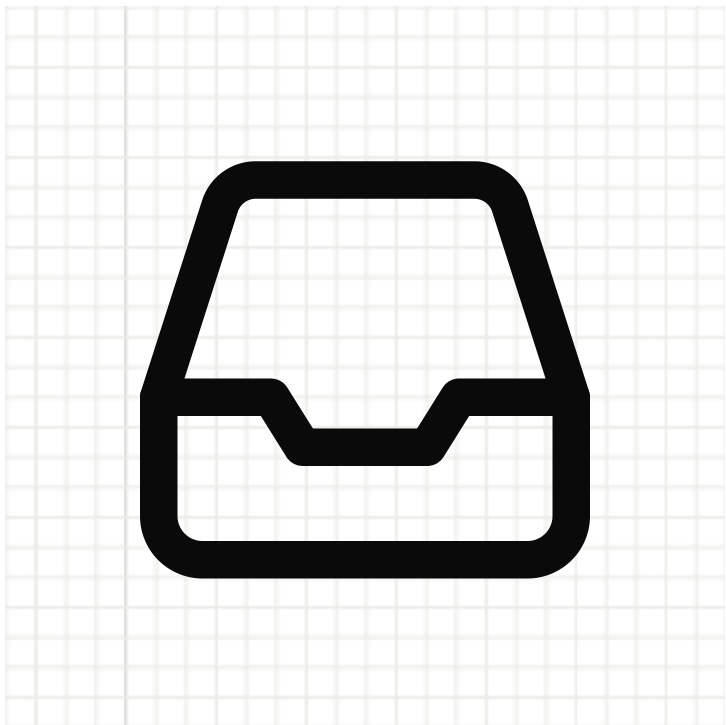


Absence

Negative space and redaction bars. Showing what was held back builds trust.

Iconography

Drawn for Halo on a 24 px grid with a 1.5 px stroke, round caps and joins, and no fills.
Light enough to sit beside Geist without shouting.

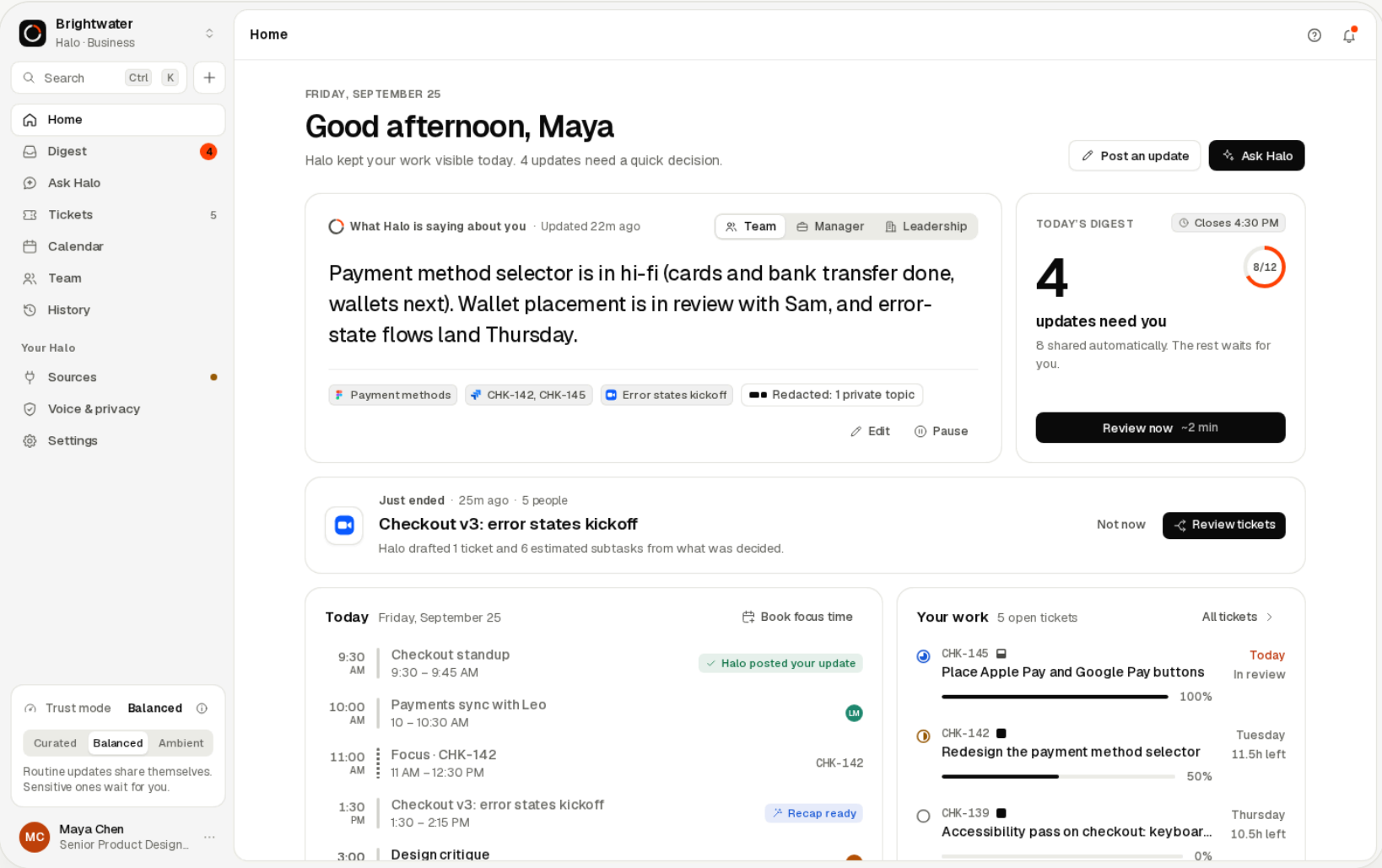


24 grid · 2 px padding · 1.5 stroke

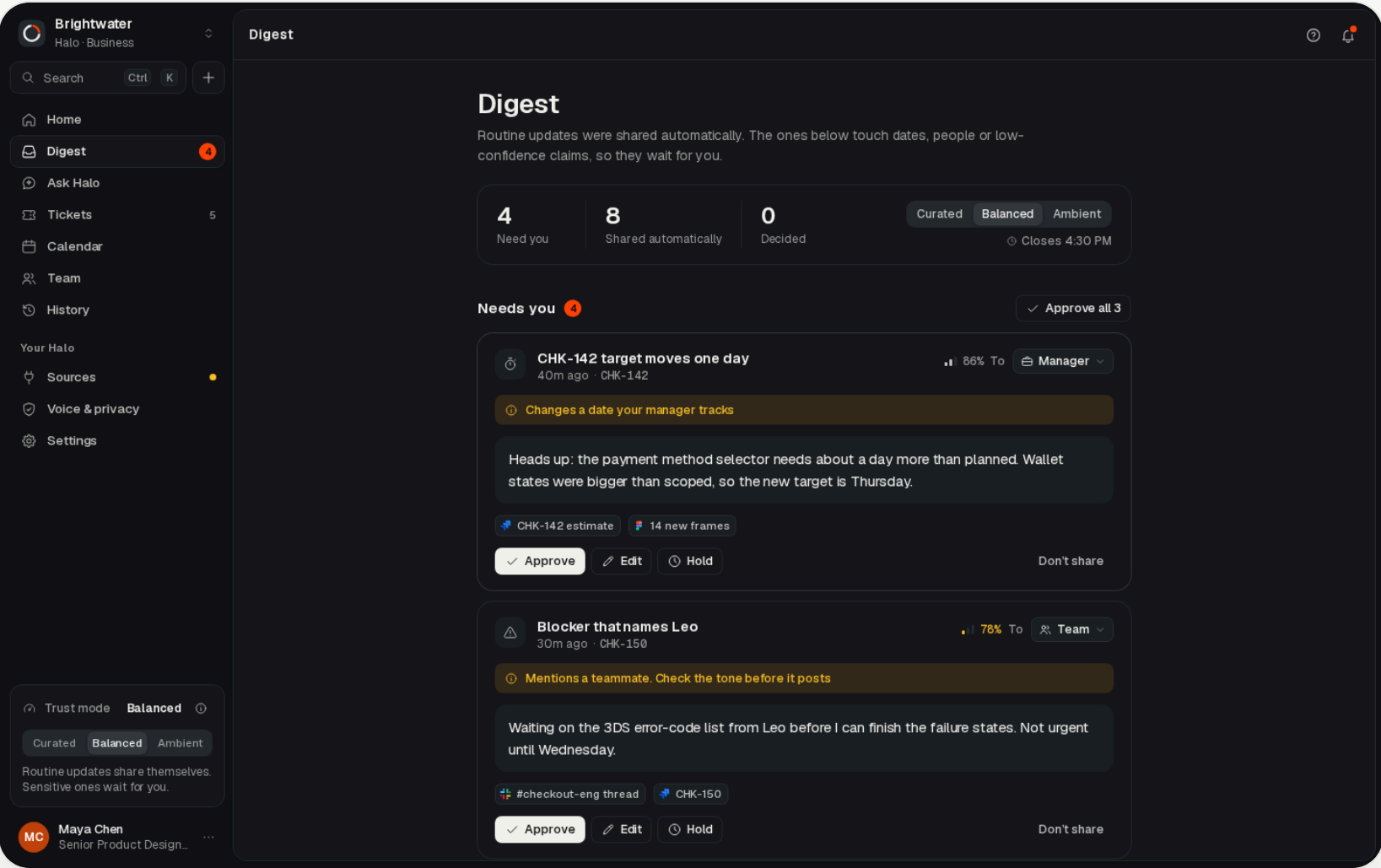
											
home	digest	ask	ticket	calendar	team	history	sources	privacy	settings	search	plus
											
check	bell	sparkle	wand	dial	subtasks	timer	flag	link	lock	eye-off	fingerprint
											
wave	broadcast	manager	exec	teammate	git-pr	frame	video	mail	message	send	share
											
download	refresh	undo	pause-circle	sun	moon	keyboard	command	filter	board	focus	split

Product interface

The brand shows up in the product as restraint: calm hierarchy, one primary action per view, and Signal only where attention is due.



Home. What Halo is saying about you, at three altitudes.



Digest, dark. The once-a-day decision point.

App icon and favicon

The mark sits on Ink with a Canvas ring, so it holds up on any wallpaper. Platforms apply their own corner mask to the full-bleed file.



220



120



64



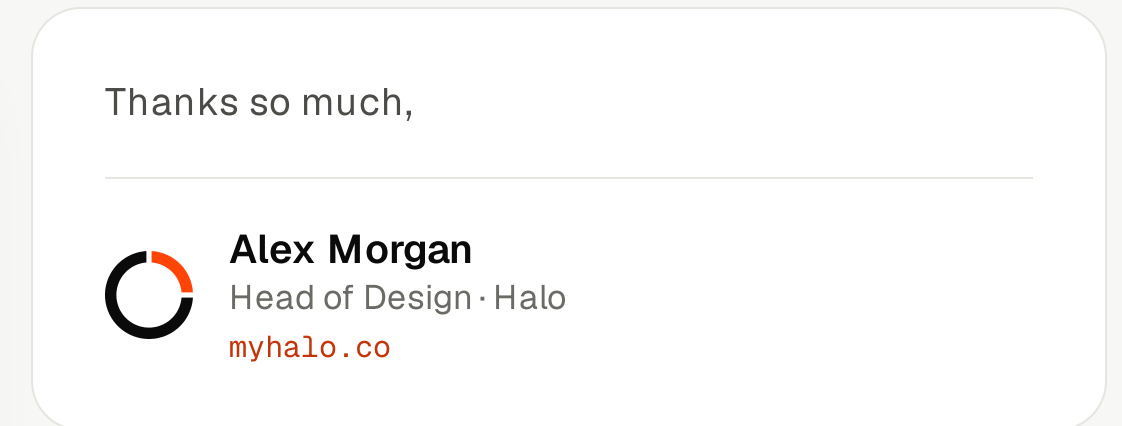
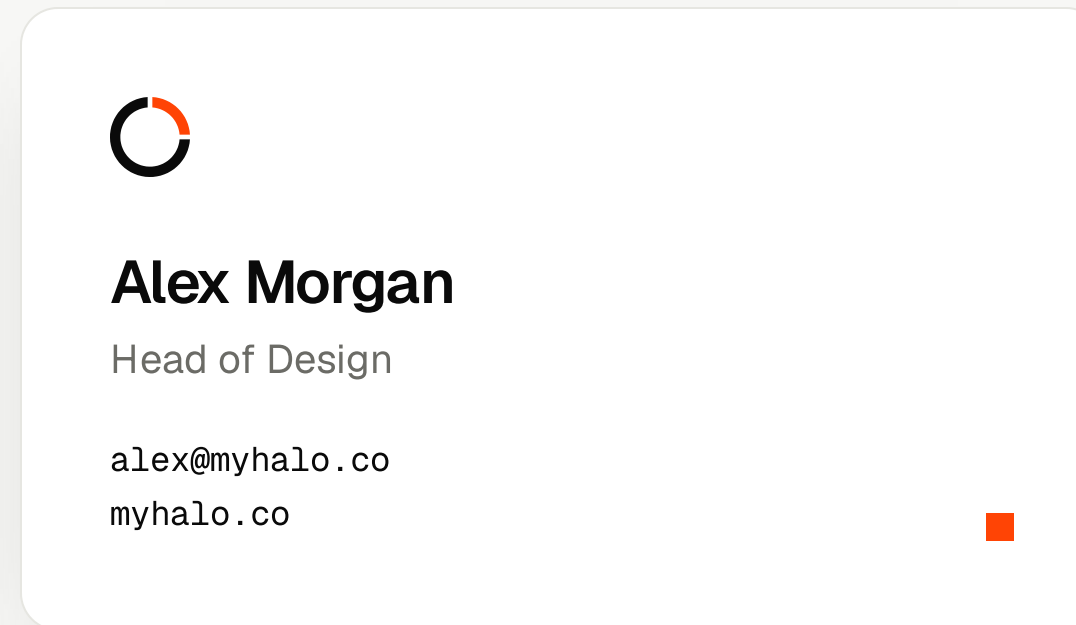
40

 Halo · Home

 Halo · Home

Print and email

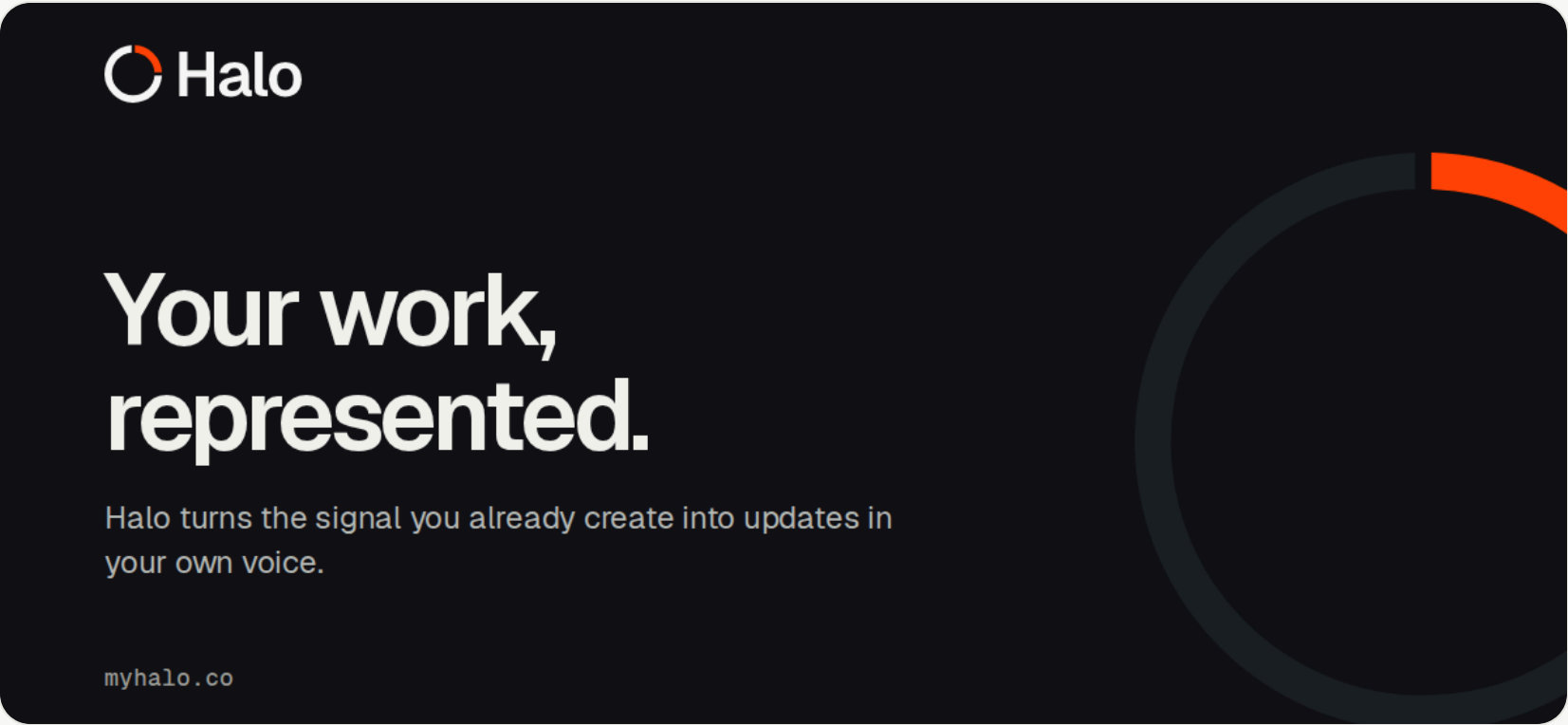
Business cards pair a reversed front with a quiet back. Email signatures use the mark at 44 px and Signal Deep for the link.



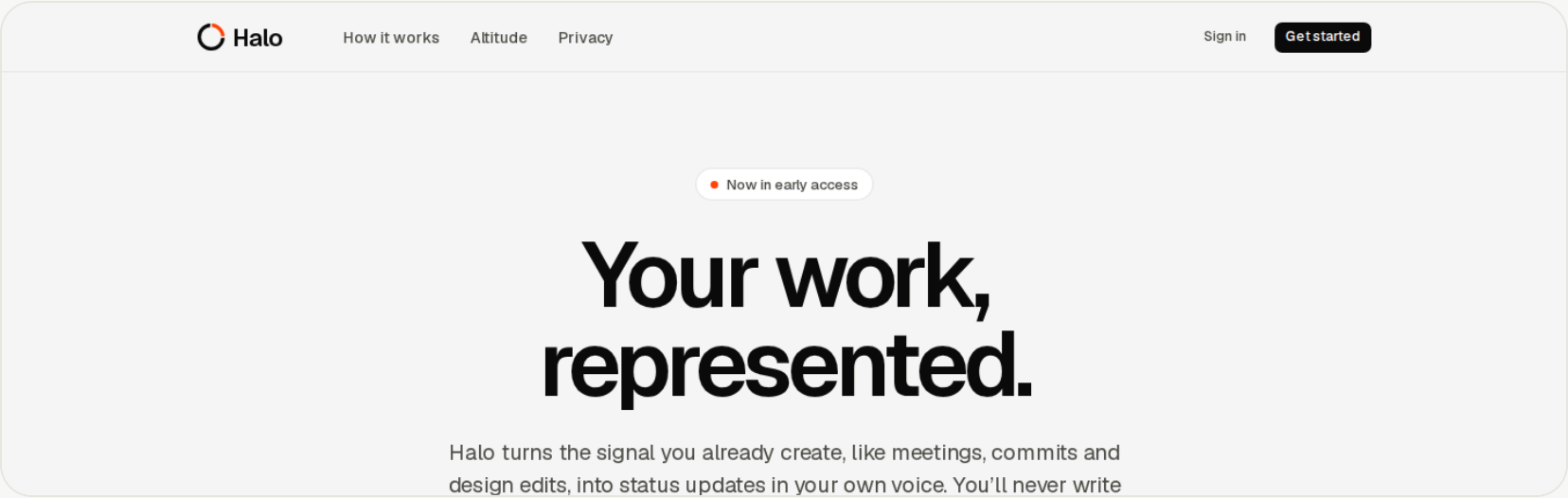
Card: 85 × 55 mm, uncoated 400 gsm. Ink prints as rich black (60/40/40/100); Signal is a spot color, never a tint.

Social and web

Midnight carries the brand on social and in presentations. The website leads with the product, not with illustration.



Link previews and profiles. 1200 × 630 for links, 400 × 400 avatar, 1500 × 500 banner.



Assets and contact

Always start from these files. Name exports as halo-<asset>-<variant>-<size>.

```
brand/
  logo/mark/      halo-mark-{color,reversed,black,white}.svg + png/
                  halo-mark-small-*.svg          (below 24 px)
  logo/wordmark/   halo-wordmark-{ink,white}.svg
  logo/lockup/     halo-lockup-{horizontal,stacked}-
{color,reversed,black,white}.svg
  app-icon/        halo-app-icon-{dark,light}[-fullbleed].svg + png/
  favicon/         favicon.svg  favicon.ico  apple-touch-icon.png  icon-*.png
  social/         og-image.png  social-banner-1500x500.png  social-avatar-400.png
  tokens/         tokens.json (W3C design tokens)  tokens.css  contrast.json
```

QUESTIONS AND APPROVALS

brand@myhalo.co

If something isn't covered here, ask before you ship it. We'd rather help early than fix it later.

